

What We Know: A Timeline of South San’s Districtwide NIET/TAP Decision

2010–11

Somerset begins NIET/TAP

With Hinojosa as superintendent, Somerset begins partnering with NIET, piloting TAP at one school and expanding it districtwide over the next several years.

Jan. – Mar. 2023

Hinojosa leaves Somerset

Hinojosa departs as superintendent at the end of January; his retirement is finalized in March.

After leaving Somerset

Hinojosa begins working with NIET

Hinojosa works with NIET as Executive in Residence; exact start date unknown.

Mar. 2024

South San Needs Assessment

The district’s **2024 Comprehensive Needs Assessment** identifies learning loss, a high at-risk population, low parent participation, teacher turnover, declining enrollment, and aging network infrastructure. **In the staff-quality section, teacher turnover – not ineffective teaching - is identified as the concern.**

Jan. 2, 2025

Hinojosa still listed with NIET

NIET organizational chart shows him as Executive in Residence.

Feb. 19, 2025

Hinojosa appointed South San Superintendent

TEA appoints Hinojosa superintendent and installs a seven-member Board of Managers.

Apr. 14, 2025

South San ISD Board Meeting

- **Saavedra indicates a new Needs Assessment** will be conducted over the following several weeks and presented to the Board when completed.
NOT LOCATED: Completed Needs Assessment or later Board Presentation
- **Board Packet April 14]**(provided to the Board of Managers prior to the meeting)
 - Describes NIET/TAP implementation
 - Historical Data included: “none”
 - **Does not include data or analysis showing teacher-practice deficiencies were driving low student achievement**
- **In his remarks, Hinojosa says** 14 teachers he describes as underperforming would not return and reports 1,875 classroom visits by central-office staff, which he describes as visits made to “support them” **No findings or teacher-effectiveness analysis are presented.**
- **Hinojosa recommends immediate implementation of NIET/TAP**, restructuring instruction around NIET/TAP’s predetermined educational model as a mechanism to improve student success. The NIET/TAP model shifts professional judgment and instructional decision-making from teachers toward compliance with externally defined practices and required structures.
- **Board of Managers approves districtwide implementation 7–0, while the new Needs Assessment is still pending.**